



Apex Legends Frenzy

An Apex Legends player spends \$500 on 500 Apex Crates just to find one heirloom bundle at the last crate. <https://digit.in/mar19-64>



Lie detector game by Hasbro

The new Lie Detector Game announced by Hasbro at New York Toy Fair claims to analyze your voice to determine truths. <https://digit.in/mar19-65>

Foldable phones are stupid

Seems like It's the notch all over again

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oldable phone are ridiculously asinine. There I said it. Anyone who thinks that the foldable

concept is here to stay should find themselves a nice corner and fold themselves a nice and pointy dunce hat. It would appear that in the race to innovate and move forward, phone manufacturers have hit a snag. Aside from packing in the latest SoC from Qualcomm and throwing in more cameras, there has been little done that can be lauded as innovations. It is at such times that manufacturers resort to an old trick – take one step backward. This wouldn't be the first time something as silly as this was done.

A recent example of the same is the notch phenomenon. We had phones with front cameras for a few years and didn't need the notch. All of a sudden, a bezel that's a few millimeters thick appeared to be a major deal-breaker. Apple came to everyone's rescue and extended the screen further towards the phone's edge and encapsulated the camera and speaker module into a notch at the top. Courageous, they called it. It was an outright travesty and the very fact that we're starting to see fewer phones with the notch are a testament to how ridiculous the entire fad was. Let's not even get started with the headphone jack removal, a move aimed at increasing accessory sales.

Coming back to foldable phones. The concept has been around for a while. In fact, the “grand-daddy” of all innovators, Apple, filed a patent for a foldable phone concept back in 2014, something that has just resurfaced a few days ago. However, they never went ahead with foldable phones, not for five whole years. Why not? Well, the technology takes time to mature. The angle of curvature up until now was very wide, it's only in recent times that you can fold screens in a manner that makes it possible to use in a smartphone. Read that again, it's only recently that it became possible to have such narrowly folded



screens i.e. this is gen-one. Essentially, everyone getting a gen-one foldable smartphone is simply a beta tester. Think of it, Samsung announced the Fold at an event late last month and the device was nowhere to be seen except in promo videos. One could argue that the event was all about the S10 variants and they didn't want to divide the attention. Well, in that case, why even bother revealing the phone in detail?

Then there are the challenges associated with adding more moving parts to a device. IPXX certification? Right

outta the window. There was no mention of the same for the Galaxy Fold nor was it anywhere at the Huawei Mate X presentation. Now let's focus on the thing that makes it “foldable”, the hinge. If we take into consideration the number of times we've experienced phones with hinges, we know for a fact that after a while, the hinge loosens up. What's worse is that a single grain of dirt can render the hinge useless. Then there's the other major issue with hinges. Any cable that has to undergo mechanical stress will tear or break over time. If you've used a laptop for a considerable amount of time then you know that the most common problem with laptops is the FRC for the display getting damaged. Now we not only have the FRC to worry about but also the battery. If manufacturers

are going to have batteries in both halves of a foldable phone, then common sense dictates that there will be a bunch of wires running across the hinge to connect both halves of the batteries in series. And when battery wires are twisted and untwisted a bazillion times, there's a good possibility that the two might get short-circuited. Let's not forget that these are Lithium-Ion batteries that we're talking about. Those things get super hot when shorted so there's a good chance that they could set off a minor explosion. If you find that hard to believe, read up the official explanation for the Note 7 battery problems.

Yes, foldable phones are fancy and will have a lot of people interested in them. Given how expensive they've been priced, it's easy to assume that not a lot are expected to be sold. So we'll be seeing more of this silliness for many more months until there's an actual innovation in the space.